AutoConcourse: A Computational Pipeline for Automatic Generation of Q-Concourse Statements

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1 Abstract

Crafting a high-quality concourse is central to Q-methodology, yet manual collection and phrasing of candidate statements remains slow, costly, and difficult to standardize across languages and issues. We present *AutoConcourse*, an end-to-end retrieval-and-generation pipeline that assembles large issue-specific corpora, organizes them via a **flexible anchor framework**, embeds text with sentence-embedding models, synthesizes concise, Q-ready statements with large language models (LLMs), and applies redundancy and balance controls prior to expert curation. We apply AutoConcourse to the generation of survey statements for the Deliberative Reasoning Index (DRI), a core outcome measure for deliberative processes whose adoption is constrained by high preparation costs. DRI relies on a set of statements representative of the public discourse on a given topic, derived from Q-methodology's concourse.

We contribute: (1) a generalizable pipeline for automatic concourse generation, (2) quantitative criteria for diversity tailored to Q-methodology, (3) empirical comparisons across *anchor-only* and *no-anchor* (unsupervised seeding) conditions, quantifying anchor-induced effects on diversity, and (4) a reproducible implementation with documented prompts, anchors, and configuration files. We explicitly note that the supervised nature of this pipeline can introduce coder priors and bias.

2 CV

Maurice Flechtner is a PhD candidate at the University of Zurich and research assistant at ETH Zurich. His research lies at the intersection of computational social science, NLP, and deliberative democracy. He works on LLM-based agent simulation (DelibSim), belief updating in language model agents, and automated

content analysis of political discourse. He holds an M.A. in Computational Social Sciences from the University of Lucerne and a B.A. in Philosophy (minor Mathematics) from HU Berlin.

3 Intended Audience

AutoConcourse facilitates the automatic generation of DRI statements, which currently requires intensive manual effort, limiting DRI's practical application. By automating this process, AutoConcourse enables practitioners and facilitators to monitor deliberative outcome quality at scale.